

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Micro-Project

PHASE 7 | PROJECT DOCUMENTATION PHASE

7. Project Documentation Phase

7.1 Project Summary

This project implements a **Flow Designer automation** in ServiceNow that eliminates manual overhead in the standard laptop procurement process. When a user orders a "Standard Laptop" from the Service Catalog and the request is approved, a Flow named "Standard Laptop task" automatically creates a Catalog Task — pre-filled with the correct short description, description, assignment group, and approval status — and routes it to the Hardware team for configuration.

7.2 Technical Documentation — Flow Configuration

Property	Value
Flow Name	Standard Laptop task
Application	Global
Run As	System User
Status	Active
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task (ServiceNow Core)
Table	Catalog Task [sc_task]

7.3 Field Mapping Reference

Field	Value	Source
Requested Item	Trigger's Requested Item record	Mapped from trigger data (Data pill)
Short Description	Laptop needs to Configured	Static value set in the action
Description	Laptop needs to Configured	Static value set via "Add field value"
Assignment group	Hardware	Static value set via "Add field value"
Approval	Approved	Static value set via "Add field value"

7.4 Catalog Item Configuration Reference

Item	Setting
Catalog Item Name	Standard Laptop
Category	Hardware
Catalog	Service Catalog
Process Engine → Flow	Standard Laptop task
Process Engine → Workflow / Execution Plan	Cleared (not used)

7.5 End-to-End Record Trail (from testing)

Record	Number	Key Attribute
Request	REQ0010001	Contains 1 Requested Item
Requested Item	RITM0010001	State: Open; 1 Catalog Task
Catalog Task	SCTASK0010001	Assignment group: Hardware; Approval: Approved

7.6 How the Automation Works (Recap)

- The user submits a request for the "Standard Laptop" catalog item, creating a Request (REQ) and a Requested Item (RITM).
- An approver reviews and approves the RITM via the Approvers related list.
- The Service Catalog trigger on the "Standard Laptop task" Flow fires.
- The "Create Catalog Task" action executes, creating a new sc_task record linked to the RITM, pre-filled with the description, assignment group, and approval values defined at design time.
- The Hardware team sees the new task in their queue, ready for configuration, with no manual task creation required.

7.7 Known Limitations & Future Enhancements

- The flow currently uses static, hard-coded field values; a future iteration could pull the description or priority dynamically from item variables for more complex standard items.

- No notification is currently sent to the requester when the Catalog Task is completed; adding a "Send Email" or "Ask For Approval" step could close this feedback loop.
- The automation is scoped to a single catalog item ("Standard Laptop"); the same flow pattern could be templated and reused for other standard hardware/software items (e.g., "Standard Monitor", "Standard Headset").
- Currently only one Assignment group (Hardware) is supported; a future version could branch the assignment group based on the requested configuration.

7.8 Outcome

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.